of his invasion of Poland used Fascist-labelling to justify their actions too. Fascism ‘suffered from an excess of definition. To cry “fascist!” suggested a lazy equation with Adolf Hitler, total war and the Holocaust. The far left further devalued the term by hurling it around to denounce everyone from capitalist bosses to mildly disciplinarian schoolteachers,’ adds Timothy Garton Ash.[153]

Similar accusations have been made against the other *enfant terrible* of the region – Poland. In 2020, Andrzej Duda, a representative of the conservative Law and Justice party, won a second term as President of Poland, consolidating the grip on power of the Law and Justice Party of Mr Kaczyński. His victory confirmed that the main Polish political divide does not lie between the left and the right, not even between the true democrats and post-communists, but mainly between the socially conservative and traditionally Catholic countryside and liberal urban Poland, although – and this is significant and interesting – the Law and Justice party has been opposed not only by the Post-Communists (SLD) and the Liberals (a coalition gathered around the Conservative-Liberal Civic Platform), but also by a coalition around the central, Christian Democratic Polish People’s Party. Furthermore, and to make things even more complicated, President Duda is considered a moderate among the Law and Justice loyalists, who in turn have far more radical coalition partners further down on the right. To complete the picture of the Polish party political landscape, a potentially promising alternative to Law and Justice is emerging in the moderately conservative *Poland 2050* party of which we may hear more in the future.

In *Poland’s Constitutional Breakdown*, Polish constit-utional lawyer Wojciech Sadurski describes in detail and convincingly what actually happened in Poland when the Law and Justice party took power for the second time in 2015. The party had already led the government between 2005 and 2007, in a coalition with other parties, but a more definite policy pattern, the one we know now, started to emerge only after 2015. It all began with the controversial replacement of constitutional judges whose terms expired in 2015, with Sadurski acknowledging that the then outgoing liberal government of the Civic Platform had already made some of the same mistakes.[154] However, with a two-thirds majority in parliament, the new government gained such a majority in the Constitutional Court that it was ‘safe’ from possible proceedings before it.